Women's Specialists of Clear Lake
Geffrey H. Klein, MD · FACOG · DABOM

400 W Medical Center Blvd, Suite 300
Webster, Texas 77598 · (281) 557-0300

FDA-Approved Weight Loss Medications

A comprehensive guide to prescription anti-obesity medications available at our practice

SEMAGLUTIDE

Semaglutide
Wegovy® (obesity) · Ozempic® (diabetes)

✅ **~15% average weight loss**

Dose: Weekly SC injection; titrate 0.25mg → 2.4mg over 16–20 weeks

Mechanism: GLP-1 receptor agonist — reduces appetite, slows gastric emptying, improves blood sugar

⚠️ **Side Effects:** Nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, constipation, headache (usually improve after 4–8 weeks)

🔴 **Avoid if:** Personal/family history of medullary thyroid cancer or MEN2, pancreatitis, pregnancy

TIRZEPATIDE

Tirzepatide
ZepBound® (obesity) · Mounjaro® (diabetes)

✅ **20–25% average weight loss — most effective AOM**

Dose: Weekly SC injection; titrate 2.5mg → up to 15mg; highest tolerated dose

Mechanism: Dual GLP-1 + GIP receptor agonist — superior weight loss vs. GLP-1 alone

⚠️ **Side Effects:** Nausea, vomiting, diarrhea, constipation (generally well tolerated with slow titration)

🔴 **Avoid if:** Same as semaglutide — medullary thyroid ca, MEN2, pancreatitis, pregnancy

LIRAGLUTIDE

Liraglutide
Saxenda® (obesity) · Victoza® (diabetes)

✅ **~5–10% weight loss; approved ages 12+**

Dose: Daily SC injection; titrate 0.6mg → 3.0mg over 5 weeks

Mechanism: GLP-1 receptor agonist (same class as semaglutide, less weight loss)

⚠️ **Side Effects:** Nausea, diarrhea, vomiting, headache, dizziness

🔴 **Avoid if:** MTC history, MEN2, gallbladder disease, suicidal behavior, renal failure

PHENTERMINE/TOPIRAMATE

Phentermine + Topiramate
Qsymia® (extended-release oral)

✅ **7–10% average weight loss**

Dose: Daily oral; titrate 3.75/23mg → 15/92mg over 12+ weeks

Mechanism: Appetite suppression (phentermine) + satiety enhancement (topiramate)

⚠️ **Side Effects:** Tingling extremities, dry mouth, dizziness, constipation, insomnia

🔴 **Avoid if:** Pregnancy (teratogenic!), glaucoma, hyperthyroidism, MAOI within 14 days

NALTREXONE/BUPROPION

Naltrexone + Bupropion
Contrave® (extended-release oral)

✅ **5–10% average weight loss**

Dose: Oral; titrate 1 tab AM → 2 tabs AM + 2 tabs PM over 4 weeks

Mechanism: Acts on hypothalamus (hunger) and mesolimbic circuit (cravings)

⚠️ **Side Effects:** Nausea (most common), constipation, headache, insomnia, dizziness

🔴 **Avoid if:** Seizure disorder, opioid use, uncontrolled hypertension, eating disorders, pregnancy

PHENTERMINE & ORLISTAT

Phentermine (Adipex-P®)
DEA Schedule IV — short-term use (≤12 weeks)

✅ **5–10% weight loss; approved age 16+**

Dose: 15–37.5mg orally every morning; max 37.5mg/day

Mechanism: Sympathomimetic amine; decreases appetite via norepinephrine release

⚠️ **Side Effects:** Increased heart rate, dry mouth, insomnia, nervousness, elevated BP

🔴 **Avoid if:** CV disease, hyperthyroidism, glaucoma, drug abuse history, MAOI use

Orlistat (Xenical® / Alli®)

✅ **5–10% weight loss; approved age 12+**

Dose: Xenical 120mg 3×/day with meals · Alli 60mg OTC

⚠️ **GI Side Effects:** Oily stools, gas with oily discharge, frequent bowel movements

🔴 **Avoid:** Malabsorption, cholestasis, warfarin use. Take daily multivitamin (fat-soluble vitamins).

QUICK COMPARISON — ALL FDA-APPROVED AOMS

Medication	Avg Weight Loss	Route	Frequency	Approx. Cost/Mo	Min Age	Key Advantage
Tirzepatide (ZepBound)	20–25%	Injection	Weekly	$$$$	18+	Best efficacy available
Semaglutide (Wegovy)	~15%	Injection	Weekly	$$$$	18+	GLP-1 gold standard
Qsymia	7–10%	Oral	Daily	$$$	18+	Strong appetite suppression
Contrave	5–10%	Oral	2×/day	$$	18+	Good for cravings/emotional eating
Phentermine	5–10%	Oral	Daily	$	16+	Lowest cost; short-term use
Liraglutide (Saxenda)	5–10%	Injection	Daily	$$$$	12+	Approved for teens 12+
Orlistat (Alli/Xenical)	5–10%	Oral	3×/day	$	12+	Only OTC option; non-systemic

The Right Medication Is the One That's Right for YOU

Dr. Klein will select the most appropriate medication based on your health history, weight loss goals, insurance coverage, and preferences. All medications work best with lifestyle modifications. Call
(281) 557-0300
to discuss your options.